

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	LADDERS - SAFE USE	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
		<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date	

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Selection of ladder	Fall Sprains Breaks	2	- The type and length of ladder appropriate to the task should be chosen. - Inspect the ladder before it is used. - Make sure it is in sound condition-clean, dry and undamaged. - If ladders show any signs of bowing in the rungs they are not to be used. - Only ladders that comply with AS/NZS 1892 series should be used and ladders should be clearly marked with Standard number. - Refer to the maximum load rating before using a ladder. - Fully enclosed, slip resistant footwear should be worn. - Metal ladders should not be used for electrical work. - Follow manufacturer's instructions for safe use.	Worker	3
Placing and securing ladders	Back injury Ladder could fall if not secure	2	- Use two persons to carry ladder to task if required. - When carrying a ladder keep the front end elevated. - Ladders shall be handled with care and not be subject to dropping, jarring or misuse. - Users must consider the weight and length of the ladder, their own physical ability and the immediate environmental conditions. - When a ladder is being carried, raised or lowered care must be taken to avoid injuring any person standing nearby, including both the operator and assistant. - Ladders are to be placed on firm and level footing. - If the ladder is to be placed near a doorway, the door should be blocked open or locked closed – Use warning signs if necessary. - The base of the ladder should be positioned out approximately ¼ of the supported height i.e. if the ladder is supported at a 4 metre height, then the base should be 1 metre out from the supporting point.	Worker	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			- Secure ladder to structure before climbing onto steps. - Have another person near the ladder, supervising the area to support the ladder when necessary. - If working alone from ladder the bottom should be secured by either lashing the ladder to stakes in the ground or by using sandbags placed at the bottom of the ladder. - Securing safe work zone around ladder- Placing barriers around to work zone not only protect the person working of the ladder but also covers public and personnel safety.		
Ascending descending & using ladder	Fall from ladder Broke bones Soft tissue damage	2	- Wear appropriate footwear (clean of grease and mud) when climbing ladders. - Have three limbs on the ladder at all times- 3 points of contact. - Never at any stage use hands to carry items on ladder. - Do not use ladder when broken, patched, oily or cracked rails, damage rungs or steps. - Only one person stands on or works from a ladder at a time. - Never stand above rung indicated by the manufacturer as the highest standing level. - When on a ladder user should remain centred between the sides. - When ascending or descending a ladder the person should face the ladder and have both hands free to grip the ladder. - Do not overreach when on a ladder. Descend and relocate the ladder.	Worker	3
Maintaining and storing ladders Store Ladders In An appropriately, dry place.	Injury from poorly maintained ladder	2	- Store stepladders vertically, in a closed position - Secure stored ladders so that they will not tip over - Remove defective ladders from service, TAG or make with words, " DANGEROUS, DO NOT USE" Ladders should be Inspected regularly.	Worker	3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken.	Supervisor All	3
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers.	Supervisor All	2
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 3. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 4. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 5. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 6. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card					
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management		
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training		

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.